

GRE Vocabulary Notes: Group 37

Group 37 Vocabulary

1. Attribute

Meaning: To regard something as caused by someone or something; also, a quality or feature.

Tip to remember: Attribute sounds like “attach tribute.” You attach a result to a cause.

Sentence: The scientist attributed the error to faulty equipment.

2. Calamitous

Meaning: Disastrous or causing great harm.

Tip to remember: Calamitous comes from calamity, meaning disaster.

Sentence: The calamitous flood destroyed many homes.

3. Censor

Meaning: To remove or suppress information considered offensive, harmful, or sensitive.

Tip to remember: Think of someone cutting parts from a movie or article before people see it. That is censoring.

Sentence: The government tried to censor critical news reports.

4. Champion

Meaning: To strongly support or defend a cause; also, a winner.

Tip to remember: GRE trick: champion can be a verb meaning support, not only a winner.

Sentence: She championed the rights of rural students.

5. Compound

Meaning: To make something worse or more intense; also, a mixture or enclosed area.

Tip to remember: GRE often uses compound as a verb: one problem adds to another and makes it worse.

Sentence: Lack of sleep compounded his stress before the exam.

6. Deter

Meaning: To discourage or prevent someone from doing something.

Tip to remember: Deter sounds like “detour.” It turns someone away from an action.

Sentence: Strict rules can deter students from cheating.

7. **Dexterous**
Meaning: Skillful with the hands or mind.
Tip to remember: Think of a skilled technician quickly fixing tiny wires. That person is dexterous.
Sentence: The surgeon was dexterous with delicate instruments.
8. **Dictum**
Meaning: A formal statement, saying, or authoritative pronouncement.
Tip to remember: Dictum sounds like dictate. A dictum is something stated with authority.
Sentence: The professor often repeated the dictum that practice beats talent.
9. **Dutiful**
Meaning: Carefully and obediently doing one's duty.
Tip to remember: Dutiful contains duty. A dutiful person does what duty requires.
Sentence: The dutiful student completed every assignment on time.
10. **Empathetic**
Meaning: Able to understand and share another person's feelings.
Tip to remember: Empathy means feeling with someone. An empathetic person understands others' emotions.
Sentence: A good teacher is empathetic toward struggling students.
11. **Ensue**
Meaning: To happen afterward as a result.
Tip to remember: Ensue sounds like "in sequence." It means what follows next.
Sentence: A heated debate ensued after the announcement.
12. **Fathom**
Meaning: To understand something deeply.
Tip to remember: A fathom measures depth in water. To fathom an idea is to understand its depth.
Sentence: He could not fathom why the experiment failed.
13. **Frank**
Meaning: Open, honest, and direct.
Tip to remember: Think of a friend who tells you the truth clearly. That friend is frank.
Sentence: She gave a frank opinion about the proposal.
14. **Germane**
Meaning: Relevant and closely related to the topic.
Tip to remember: Germane sounds like "germane to," which means related to.
Sentence: Please include only germane points in your essay.
15. **Grumble**
Meaning: To complain quietly or in a low voice.

Tip to remember: Grumble sounds like the low rumbling sound of complaint.
Sentence: The students grumbled about the difficult homework.

16. **Hidebound**

Meaning: Unwilling to change because of tradition or old habits.

Tip to remember: Think of someone bound tightly by old ideas and unable to move forward.

Sentence: The hidebound committee rejected every modern suggestion.

17. **Hypocrite**

Meaning: A person who pretends to have moral beliefs that they do not actually follow.

Tip to remember: Think of someone saying “be honest” while secretly lying. That person is a hypocrite.

Sentence: He was called a hypocrite for criticizing corruption while taking bribes.

18. **Impolitic**

Meaning: Unwise or not sensible, especially in social or political situations.

Tip to remember: Politic means wise or tactful. Impolitic means not wise or tactful.

Sentence: It was impolitic to criticize the manager during the meeting.

19. **Insidious**

Meaning: Harmful in a gradual, hidden, or subtle way.

Tip to remember: Think of poison spreading slowly without being noticed. That is insidious.

Sentence: The insidious effects of misinformation can damage society over time.

20. **Intermediary**

Meaning: A person or thing that acts between two sides; a mediator.

Tip to remember: Intermediary contains “middle.” It stands in the middle between two parties.

Sentence: The lawyer acted as an intermediary between the company and workers.

21. **Passive**

Meaning: Not active; accepting what happens without resistance.

Tip to remember: A passive person lets things pass without acting.

Sentence: He remained passive during the discussion and offered no ideas.

22. **Raillery**

Meaning: Light, playful teasing.

Tip to remember: Think of friends gently teasing each other without cruelty. That is raillery.

Sentence: Their conversation was full of friendly raillery.

23. **Ramble**

Meaning: To speak or walk without clear direction.

Tip to remember: Think of someone talking endlessly without a clear point. That

person rambles.

Sentence: The speaker rambled for twenty minutes before reaching the main idea.

24. **Resent**

Meaning: To feel anger or bitterness because of unfair treatment.

Tip to remember: Resent sounds like “re-sent anger.” The anger keeps coming back.

Sentence: The workers resented the unfair salary policy.

25. **Residual**

Meaning: Remaining after most of something has gone or been removed.

Tip to remember: Residual comes from residue, the leftover part.

Sentence: The machine still had residual heat after being switched off.

26. **Resolve**

Meaning: To solve; to decide firmly; determination.

Tip to remember: GRE trick: resolve can mean solve a problem or strong determination.

Sentence: She showed great resolve while preparing for the exam.

27. **Surrogate**

Meaning: A substitute or replacement for another person or thing.

Tip to remember: Think of someone serving in another person’s place. That person is a surrogate.

Sentence: The assistant acted as a surrogate for the absent manager.

28. **Vilify**

Meaning: To speak badly about someone in order to damage their reputation.

Tip to remember: Vilify sounds like villain. To vilify someone is to make them look like a villain.

Sentence: The newspaper tried to vilify the activist.

29. **Wanting**

Meaning: Lacking or deficient in something.

Tip to remember: GRE trick: wanting does not always mean desiring; it can mean lacking.

Sentence: His explanation was wanting in evidence.

30. **Willful**

Meaning: Deliberate and intentional; stubbornly determined.

Tip to remember: Willful contains will. A willful action is done by choice, often stubbornly.

Sentence: The damage was not accidental; it was willful.